



Life saver

The US Navy Mark 2 pneumatic life vest was standard issue for naval aviators and aircrews throughout the Vietnam War. It is not known how many US pilots shot down over water owe their lives to this kit.

Massive costs

During the course of the operation, the United States dropped more than 900,000 tons of bombs on North Vietnam, an effort that resulted in the loss of some 950 American aircraft and more than a thousand American airmen killed, captured, or wounded. Despite civilian casualties in excess of 1,000 per month, North Vietnam's morale held and its claim on the South never wavered.